

ELTE Student Visa & Residence Permit Guide

1. Who Needs What? A Quick Overview

Your legal status in Hungary depends on your nationality and the length of your stay.

- **EEA Students (EU, Norway, Switzerland, Iceland, Liechtenstein):**
 - You do **NOT** need a visa or residence permit.
 - You **MUST** obtain a **Registration Certificate** upon arrival.
- **Non-EEA Students (Staying longer than 90 days):**
 - You need a **Residence Permit for the Purpose of Study**.
 - You may also need a **D-type visa** to enter Hungary.
 - **Check if you need a visa here:** [Link to official visa checker]
- **Non-EEA Students (Staying less than 90 days):**
 - If you are from a visa-waiver country, you can enter with your passport.
 - If you require a visa, you must apply for a **short-stay (C-type) visa**. This cannot be converted into a residence permit.

2. The Key Difference: Visa vs. Residence Permit

- **Visa (D-type):** A **travel document** that allows you to enter Hungary. It is valid for a maximum of 3 months and for a single entry. Your residence permit is issued alongside it.
- **Residence Permit:** A **residency document** that allows you to live legally in Hungary. It is valid for up to 3 years and is extendable. You must have this card to re-enter Hungary after travel.

3. Step-by-Step: Applying for Your First Residence Permit

For Non-EEA Students Applying from Abroad:

1. **Receive your Letter of Acceptance** from ELTE.
2. **Pay the tuition fee** for the first semester (if you are a self-funded student).
3. **Secure accommodation** in Hungary and have the official documents ready.
4. **Apply immediately** at the nearest Hungarian Embassy or Consulate in your home country for a **D-visa and residence permit**.

For Non-EEA Students Already in Hungary (Visa-free nationals):

1. After arrival, submit your **residence permit application online** via the **Enter Hungary** platform.

4. How to Extend Your Residence Permit

You must apply for an extension before your current permit expires.

When to Apply:

- If your permit was issued **BEFORE January 1, 2024**: Apply at least **45 days** before expiry.
- If your permit was issued **AFTER January 1, 2024**: Apply at least **30 days** before expiry.

Application Process:

1. **Submit Online:** Apply on the **Enter Hungary** website. Submit on time even if some documents are missing. You can upload them later.
2. **Book an Appointment:** After online submission, you must book an appointment and visit the **National Directorate-General for Aliens Policing (NDGAP)** in person within 15 days to provide your biometrics (fingerprints, photo).
3. **Pay Fee:** The procedural fee is **26,000 HUF** (waived for Stipendium Hungaricum and other scholarship holders).

Required Documents for Extension:

- Valid Passport
- Current Residence Permit Card and Address Card (QR code)
- Proof of Tuition Fee Payment for the next semester
- Certificate of Active Student Status (request via Q-tér)
- Transcript of Records
- Valid Accommodation Proof (e.g., lease agreement)

Special Case for Graduates: If your permit expires just before your graduation ceremony and you do not plan to stay, contact **visa@elte.hu** for assistance with a temporary certificate.

5. Important Rules and Warnings

- **Always Keep Your Documents:** Your residence permit is only valid **together with your passport and your address card (QR code)**. Always carry all three.
- **Active Student Status:** Your residence permit is tied to your active student status. If you take a **passive semester, your permit becomes invalid**, and you must leave Hungary.
- **Academic Progress:** The immigration authorities can revoke your permit if you fail to obtain your degree within **1.5 times the standard duration** of your program.
- **Work Rights:** With a student residence permit, you can work **up to 30 hours per week during the semester** and full-time for a maximum of **90 days per year** outside of semesters.
- **Travel Warning:**
 - Do **NOT** leave Hungary before you receive your physical residence permit card.
 - Do **NOT** travel with a Temporary Residence Permit (*ideiglenes tartózkodási igazolás*). You will not be allowed back in.
- **Family Reunification:** It is **not possible** for family members to get a residence permit based on your student status.

6. Key Contacts for Help

- **ELTE Visa Coordinator (Dr. Zoltán Kalácska):** **visa@elte.hu**
 - Include your full name, Neptun code, and nationality in your email.
- **National Directorate-General for Aliens Policing (NDGAP):**
 - **Address:** 1135 Budapest, Szegedi út 35-37

- **Email:** bp2@oif.gov.hu
- **Website:** <https://oif.gov.hu>

7. Essential Links for More Information

- **Residence Permit for the Purpose of Study (Official Factsheet):** <https://oif.gov.hu/factsheets/extend-your-permit-student>
- **Enter Hungary Application Platform:** <https://enterhungary.gov.hu/>
- **ELTE Visa FAQ Page:** [FAQ](#)